

“Good coding skills and the correct attitude can get you hired”

The job scenario in the IT world looks a bit gloomy with the current economic slowdown. But companies like NetApp are all set to buck the trend and continue with ‘smart’ hiring. **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You** spoke to **Santhosh D’Souza**, director, Systems Engineering at NetApp India, about the hiring of engineering talent in the company. Excerpts:

Q In general, do you find a growing acceptance for open source technology?

Oh yes, absolutely! If you look at the IT environment, you will find a whole set of technologies and products that have emerged directly out of the open source environment. If you were to look at the operating systems side, various Linux distributions have become widely accepted across verticals in India. If you take the application environment and Web server environment, a whole lot of open source technologies are being used in both, including projects like Apache and so on. In the case of databases, open source databases are perhaps not as ubiquitously deployed as commercial database software, but they are deployed in a variety of organisations. With messaging and collaboration, a wide array of open source technology is being used there. In default desktop browsers, a large share of that market is based on open source technology. So over the years, we have seen increasing acceptance of open source technology.

The one thing that probably hindered the adoption of open source technology earlier was the uncertainty around support and the continued enhancement of products. But, open source communities have proved themselves to be viable in the long run, in terms of continuity and product enhancement. Communities like Apache are a testimony to that. This was a primary concern earlier and it has been addressed over time. The other aspect is that increasingly, there have been IT services and systems integrators, who have incorporated competencies around open source platforms, so that they can effectively support the deployments in the enterprise market place. That has begun to alleviate concerns around the portability of open source technologies. So, service providers also incorporate a wide variety of open source technologies in their environments, particularly because they have hired the skillsets that enable them to support open source technologies effectively. So, there has been a significant increase in the adoption and acceptance of open source technologies, both in the private space as well as in the government set-up.

Santhosh D’Souza, director,
Systems Engineering at NetApp India

